CHS iPhone Installation Guide

CHS — Getting the App onto an iPhone

The direct answer

“Add to Home Screen” is the correct, real answer — not a workaround or a lesser substitute. Apple doesn’t allow the kind of direct app-file installation Android does, but Safari’s own built-in install feature does something very similar: it places a real icon on the home screen that opens the app full-screen, with no browser address bar — genuinely feeling like an installed app.

A real gap was found and fixed before these instructions were written: the technical setting that makes iOS treat CHS as a real app was already in place, but there was no properly-sized app icon configured specifically for iOS. Without that fix, “Add to Home Screen” would have shown a generic or broken-looking icon instead of the real CHS logo. This has been corrected.

Step-by-step: installing CHS on an iPhone

1. **Send the real, live app link** — the same Netlify address already in use. No file to install, no email attachment — just the link.
2. **Open it in Safari specifically.** This only works in Safari, not Chrome or any other browser on iPhone — this is an Apple restriction, not something CHS controls.
3. **Tap the Share icon** — the square with an arrow pointing up, found in Safari’s bottom toolbar.
4. **Scroll down and tap “Add to Home Screen.”**
5. **Confirm the name** (it will show “CHS”) **and tap “Add”** in the top-right corner.
6. **A real CHS icon now sits on the home screen**, next to every other app. Tapping it opens CHS full-screen, exactly like the Android experience.

One honest limitation, worth knowing upfront

iOS treats “Add to Home Screen” apps a little more conservatively than Android for things like push notifications — they still work, but may behave slightly differently. For everyday use and testing, this genuinely won’t matter. It only becomes relevant later, if CHS is ever published as a full native App Store app.